

PROJECT DOCUMENT

Note on Enclosed Materials

For Mayor Ito — meeting materials

v1.6 · 2026-09-24 · Rob Oudendijk

Mayor Ito,

Today's set of documents is a **draft** snapshot of where the project stands, including a revised haiku — walnuts, Mitsue, "75 years growing the forest," and new seeds for the next generation.

I'm also enclosing three documents on the project's current state, following on from the trifold pamphlet I gave you earlier, and showing how the work connects to what you've already said in council. None of this is a sales pitch.

Enclosed Documents

- 1. Stakeholder Network Diagram (A4, 2 pages)** — Existing relationships: landowners, forest cooperative, Niwa Sawmill, Mitsue Kanko, village office. No new organization or authority proposed.
- 2. Collective Timeline Guide (A4, 4 pages)** — Follows the spirit of the village's "100-Year Plan," laid out in decades. The purpose is completing what the generation that planted the cedars set out to do — not money.
- 3. Forest-Led Model Diagram (A3, 1 page)** — One-page summary: forest labor and reforestation through the cooperative structure the village already has, with energy and the data center following from that.

Connection to What You Have Already Said

Not a new idea — these follow directly from council sessions:

- **December 2020:** named the shortage of receiving forestry operators and workers as the real bottleneck, ahead of owner willingness or timber supply.
- **March 2021:** noted four 協力隊 members training in self-managed forestry at the cooperative, and a policy of using thinned wood at tourism facilities.
- **June 2026:** confirmed the forestry 協力隊 position has drawn almost no applicants for two years. Noted the 起業人/プロジェクトマネージャー programs weren't abandoned, only unmatched so far.
- **December 2024:** after a clear-cut notification, the village can only encourage replanting — no binding requirement. Related: on 2026-08-25 I visited an active reforestation site in Tenkawa Village with more trees (NGO) — native broadleaf on former ski-resort land, backed by rotating corporate sponsors since 2021. A working example of a mechanism that could fill that gap.

The three documents each start from one of these points: building real receiving capacity for forestry labor, using thinned wood locally, and filling the reforestation gap.

Concrete Steps Toward Attracting Labor

- **NAIST:** a seminar on this project is **confirmed** for January 2027.
- **Nara Forester Academy:** a possible seminar is being discussed (via Prof. Takuo Dome, Osaka University); we'll keep you updated.

Both are concrete channels connecting outside interest to Mitsue.

We would welcome your continued guidance.

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